

PIN). If the amount to be serviced is larger than a cut-off a third password is sent to your registered number for a one-time authentication.

Ultimately, it is again the human error of judgement that is the biggest potential loophole in the service, because catching all of the other information on the fly is probably too big an ask from today's technology.

In the context of digital payments, you might've also heard of...

NFC

Now here is another sci-fi addition to your digital payment arsenal. Gone are the days of "tap to pay your bills" meaning learning to tap-dance professionally. Now you can literally pay your bills with a tap of your phone. Near Field Communication is super-short range radio based transmission. It was built to allow communication up to a few centimetres, but the implementation in mobiles (obviously) worked towards optimizing upon the 'tapping' novelty. Smart move, too – we all know how Infrared was perceived. Now this might be a bubble, as we've witnessed with so many new technologies (not necessarily of this particular field of service). But NFC sure does show a lot of promise. Visa seems to have



got on the bandwagon early, with the release of its payWave user interface SDK, for participation in the potential release of NFC enabled applications. payWave is an attempt to make all transactions contactless, be it your everyday card, phone, or some other device that turns up someday – because there is no contact, the carrier might not matter anymore in the future. That is the vision, anyway. Not to be left behind, MasterCard has gone on the release of its PayPass interface, that would solve a similar purpose.

As for the security of the system, it is surprisingly low. As with the regular credit/debit cards, there is only an identifier in the form of the RFID chip (similar to the magnetic strip on the regular cards). The difficulty with NFC is that here, since you do not hand over your card/phone at any time,